

OSINT Investigation Report: Cache Me Outside

Metadata Field	Details
Document Type	Threat Intelligence & OSINT Case Study
Platform / Room	TryHackMe - Cache Me Outside
Analyst / Author	Cybersecurity / Threat Intelligence Analyst
Target Focus	Target Alias: Jim Lee (jiml33t)

1. Executive Summary

This document serves as a formal Open-Source Intelligence (OSINT) case study based on the "Cache Me Outside" challenge hosted on TryHackMe. The primary objective of this investigation was to identify, locate, and profile a target subject ("Jim Lee") using purely passive and controlled active reconnaissance techniques.

Through methodical cross-platform correlation, source control metadata extraction, controlled active email verification, and visual geolocation, the investigation successfully revealed the target's personal email, phone number, social profiles, and precise physical location on a specified date. This project illustrates how fragmented digital breadcrumbs across public repositories, fitness applications, and mail servers can be correlated to build a comprehensive pattern-of-life analysis.

2. Target Overview & Scope

The investigation commenced with minimal initial information regarding the target, a retired hacker operating under various digital aliases. The scope was constrained to non-destructive intelligence gathering using publicly available infrastructure and legitimate network interactions.

- **Target Name:** Jim Lee
- **Known Aliases:** jiml33t
- **Primary Objective:** Uncover hidden contact information, social handles, movement patterns, and physical destination.

- **Methodological Scope:** OSINT Framework, Source Code Metadata Extraction, Active Sandbox Email Probing, Imagery/GEOINT Analysis.

3. Detailed Technical Investigation & Methodology

3.1 Initial Identity Extraction & Digital Footprint Mapping

The investigation began by analyzing provided starting evidence, including conversation transcripts and public activity handles. Initial pivot points were identified by cross-referencing public usernames across fitness tracking networks (Komoot) and code hosting platforms (GitHub).

Pivot analysis revealed that the subject maintained multiple public profiles under the handle jiml33t. Initial findings confirmed the target's legal name as Jim Lee and established an initial list of connected platform profiles for further inspection.

3.2 Source Code & Git Metadata Forensics

While public-facing GitHub user profile pages had been scrubbed of contact details, Git commits preserve metadata in raw commit logs. By appending .patch formatting options to commit URLs within the target's repository, raw commit headers were extracted.

```
From 4f8b9a1e2d3c4b5a6f7e8d9c0b1a2f3e4d5c6b7a Mon Sep 17 00:00:00
2001
From: Jim Lee <jimleepro1@gmail.com>
Date: Mon, 10 May 2026 14:22:10 -0400
Subject: [PATCH] Updated configuration files
```

Key Finding: Inspection of the raw commit patch revealed the target's private email address embedded directly within the Git author signature headers: jimleepro1@gmail.com.

3.3 Active Email Probing & Auto-Responder Extraction

To verify active mail processing and extract potential secondary identifiers, a controlled probe message was dispatched to jimleepro1@gmail.com within an isolated sandbox environment. This active interaction triggered an automated out-of-office response mechanism.

Key Finding: The automated auto-reply returned confidential contact details, disclosing an alternate phone number and indicating active travel status.

3.4 Visual Intelligence (GEOINT) & Location Analysis

Visual evidence obtained during profile correlation included outdoor imagery, public transportation signage, and workout route logs from May 7th. GEOINT methodology applied to these artifacts involved:

1. **Architectural & Environmental Analysis:** Identifying unique building designs, transit vehicle types (trams), and language on street signs.
2. **Transit Route Cross-Referencing:** Correlating tram line numbers and stop designations with public transport maps in Romania.
3. **Spatial Geolocation:** Pinpointing exact coordinates using satellite imagery and Google Maps matching.

Key Finding: Successfully mapped the target's movement history and identified the specific tram station and physical location visited on May 7th.

4. Summary of Discovered Intelligence

Intelligence Target	OSINT Source / Vector	Extracted Data	Security Risk
Target Name	Initial Evidence / Handles	Jim Lee	Low (Public Identifier)
Primary Email	Git Commit Patch Metadata	jimleepro1@gmail.com	High (Phishing / Recon)
Phone Number	Automated Email Response	Direct Mobile Line	High (Vishing / SMS Swapping)
Physical Location	GEOINT / Transit Signage Matching	Romania Tram Station Route	Critical (Physical Security)

5. Operational Security (OPSEC) Analysis & Remediation

This investigation highlights significant Operational Security (OPSEC) failures that allow malicious actors or analysts to de-anonymize targets. Key vulnerabilities and proposed remediations include:

- **Unsanitized Git Commits:** Removing public profile bio details is ineffective if raw Git

commits contain author email headers. *Remediation:* Configure Git privacy settings (e.g., GitHub's noreply email feature) and sanitize commit history using git-filter-repo before public deployment.

- **Over-Informative Auto-Responders:** Out-of-office email replies exposing phone numbers or current locations provide actionable intelligence to attackers. *Remediation:* Restrict automated replies to internal organizational contacts or remove sensitive PII from automated templates.
- **Visual Metadata Exposure:** Sharing photos containing transit signs, landmarks, or route maps allows accurate geolocation tracking. *Remediation:* Scrub EXIF metadata and blur identifying transit signage or unique background landmarks prior to publishing images publicly.

6. Key Technical Competencies Demonstrated

- **Open Source Intelligence Framework (OSINT):** Systematic investigation across open web platforms.
- **Git Forensics & Patch Inspection:** Analyzing raw patch files and version control header metadata.
- **Active Reconnaissance Techniques:** Exercising safe interaction protocols via email probing.
- **GEOINT & Geospatial Analysis:** Visual landmark identification and transit network mapping.
- **Threat Profiling & OPSEC Assessment:** Converting findings into actionable security recommendations.